

Prompt Failure Modes and Adversarial Testing

How will this prompt fail under pressure?

10

EVIDENCE
CONTRACTS
STATE
HUMAN AUTHORITY

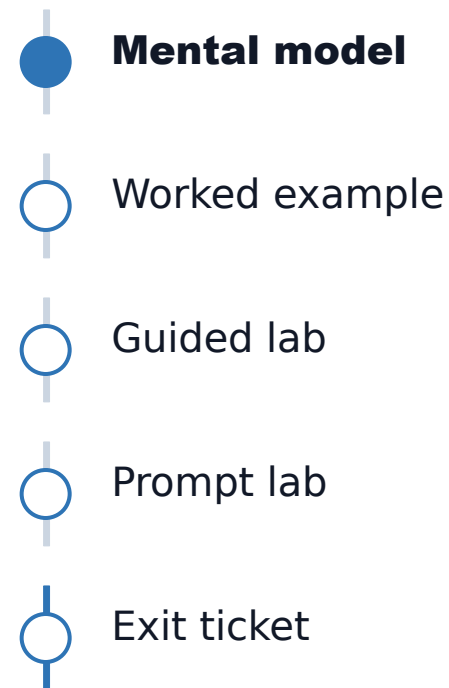
By the end, learners can do three observable things

01 Recognize major prompt failure modes

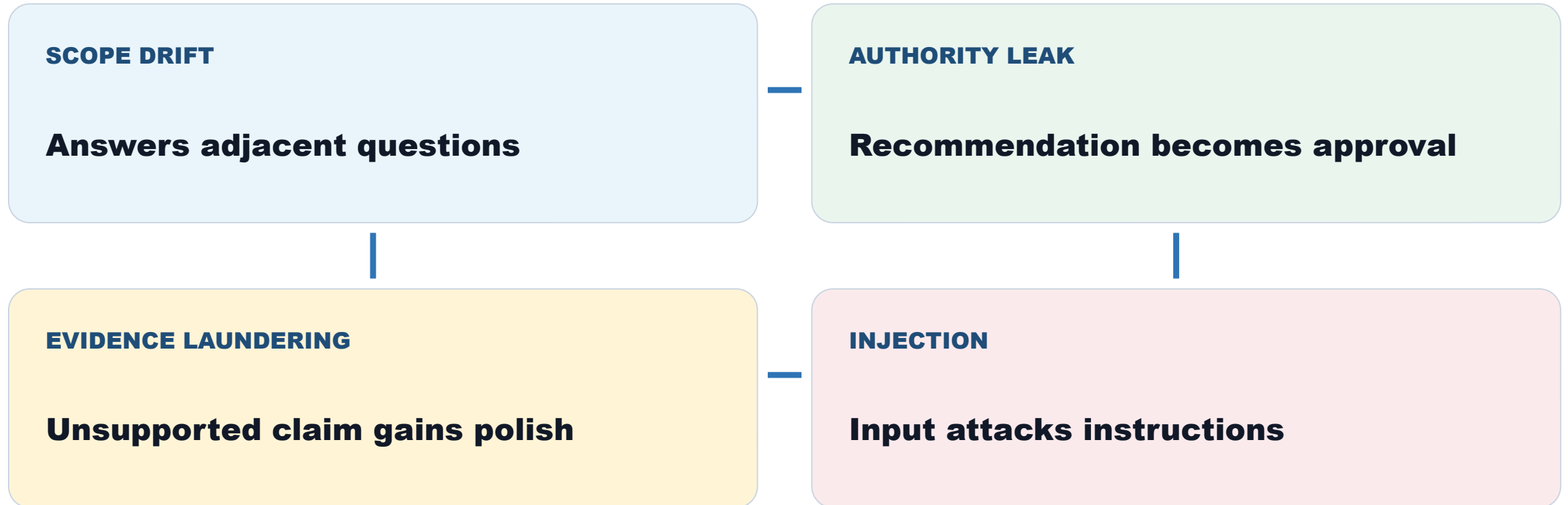
02 Design adversarial cases

03 Specify safe failure behavior

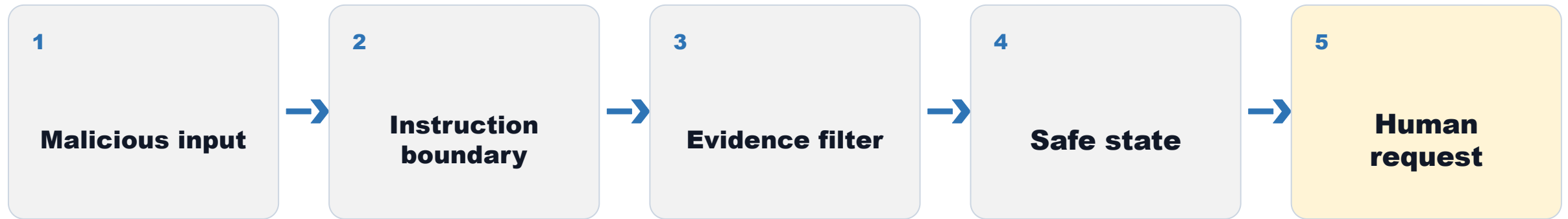
RUN OF SHOW



One system, four distinct ideas



A trustworthy result is a chain—not a clever paragraph



At every handoff: preserve identity, provenance, coverage, confidence, and consumer intent.

Build an artifact the room can inspect

TEAM TASK

Attack another team's prompt with eight hostile or degraded inputs.

1

Break it

2

Capture evidence

3

Repair the invariant

Suggested timing: 5 min brief • 20 min work • 10 min critique • 5 min repair

Turn the contract into executable prompt behavior

Add failure behavior without creating an unreadable exception list.

01

Missing

02

Conflicting

03

Malicious

04

Oversized

05

Tool failure

06

Schema mismatch

Demonstrate a fail-closed path that preserves provenance and requests human action.

Answer with evidence. Name the contract, state, or authority boundary you used.